

US equities slip marginally as yields rise and volatility spikes

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

The S&P 500 held near 7,704.13 (-0.02%) while the Nasdaq edged up to 30,478.86 (+0.03%). The 10-year Treasury yield jumped +0.94% to 5.16%, pushing the VIX to 15.67 (+3.23%). Energy prices fell, with WTI at 92.78 (-1.93%), and the communications sector led ETF gains, up +1.27%.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,704.13	-0.02%	
Dow Jones	51,349.98	-0.31%	
Nasdaq 100	30,478.86	+0.03%	
Russell 2000	2,835.57	-0.11%	
VIX	15.67	+3.23%	Volatility spike
10Y Yield	5.16%	+0.94%	Highest since March
WTI Crude	92.78	-1.93%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
META	777.59	+4.50%
GOOGL	342.36	+1.34%
JPM	338.56	+0.31%
AVGO	350.36	-1.30%
GS	923.29	-1.40%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	META
Q3 Revenue	41.2 bn
YoY Growth	+12.5%
EPS	3.21
Guidance	Revenue +9% YoY, EPS +8%

Meta posted a surprise revenue beat and a 4.5% share price jump, driven by stronger ad spend in Asia-Pacific and a rebound in Reels monetisation. The upbeat guidance has lifted sentiment in the communications sector, reflected in XLC's **+1.27%** gain.

Macro & Fed

- Fed policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)

- 10-year Treasury yield: 5.16% (+0.94%)
- Key data releases (HKT): CPI 09:30, Core PCE 10:30, ISM Manufacturing 13:00

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions ease after cease-fire talks, reducing oil-supply risk.
- China's export data due tomorrow; markets watching for signs of demand rebound.
- Eurozone manufacturing contraction deepens, pressuring the EUR to **-0.07%** against the DXY.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30	AAPL	iPhone 17 launch impact on margins
10:00	MSFT	Azure growth vs AI-related capex
11:15	NVDA	GPU demand amid AI spend slowdown
13:30	JPM	Net interest income after rate peak

Stocks worth watching

- **AMZN** – modest upside on cloud-services beat.
- **XLE** – energy ETF gaining on lower crude, could reverse on supply news.
- **XLV** – health-care defensive play as volatility rises.
- **TSLA** – price pressure after marginal Q3 miss.
- **XLC** – communications sector rally on Meta's guidance.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected rise in CPI ($>0.3\%$ MoM) could push yields above 5.30%.
- Geopolitical escalation in the Middle East reigniting oil-price risk.
- Weak earnings from **NVDA** or **GS** breaching support.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Meta's guidance spurs broader tech rally, lifting Nasdaq $>0.5\%$.
- Positive China export surprise lifts global risk appetite.
- Fed signals pause on rate hikes, supporting equity valuations.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — S&P 500

CNBC — VIX

SEC — Filings

Federal Reserve — Monetary Policy